



UAE Presidential Court

UAE, EGYPT EXPLORE WAYS TO BOOST TIES

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Egyptian President Abdul Fattah Al Sissi discussed bilateral ties and explored ways to enhance cooperation between the two nations in Abu Dhabi yesterday. The two leaders also welcomed the ceasefire deal in Gaza.



WAM

MOHAMMAD HONOURS 'ARAB GENIUSES'

His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum presents the Great Arab Minds award to Professor Yasmine Belkaid, President of Institut Pasteur, yesterday during a ceremony held at the Museum of the Future in Dubai. He also honoured five other winners of the award. **SEE ALSO P5**

Israeli strikes kill 75 despite ceasefire deal

HAMAS DENIES BACKTRACKING AS ISRAEL HOLDS OFF CABINET VOTE

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

Israel carried out fresh air strikes on Gaza killing 75 Palestinians yesterday and accused Hamas of backtracking on parts of a fragile ceasefire and hostage release deal, holding off on a cabinet vote.

“As we were celebrating the ceasefire announcement, the Israeli warplanes took us by surprise. I woke up to find myself lying in hospital with head injuries,” a boy with a bandaged head told a news channel at the site of the attack.

“All my brothers and my aunts were killed. I miraculously survived as a civil defence member pulled me from under the rubble.”

The truce, announced by mediators Qatar and the US on Wednesday, would take effect on Sunday and involve the exchange of Israeli hostages for Palestinian prisoners.

But the office of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said that Hamas had “reneged on parts of the agreement reached... in an effort to extort last-minute concessions”.

It also said that the Israeli cabinet, which has yet to approve the agreement, “will not convene until the mediators notify Israel that Hamas has accepted all elements of the agreement”.

‘Baseless accusations’

Hamas political bureau member Sami Abu Zuhri said there was “no basis” for Israel’s accusations.

In Gaza, the civil defence agency said Israel pounded several areas of the territory after the deal was announced, killing at least 75 people and wounding hundreds more. Hamas’s armed wing warned that Israel’s continuing air strikes endangered hostages who are to be freed under the agreement.

“Any aggression and shelling at this stage by the enemy could turn the freedom of a prisoner into a tragedy,” the Ezzedine Al Qassam Brigades said on Telegram.

However, US Secretary of State Antony Blinken voiced confidence that the implementation of a ceasefire would begin on Sunday. “I am confident, and I fully expect that implementation will begin, as we said, on Sunday,” Blinken said at a farewell news conference. **SEE ALSO P11**

Saif’s stabbing sparks security scare

Incident puts safety concerns of celebrities in spotlight

DUBAI
BY MANJUSHA RADHAKRISHNAN
Entertainment Editor



■ Saif Ali Khan

morning. He is now recovering at Lilavati Hospital.

The incident has drawn comparisons to Kim Kardashian’s 2016 Paris robbery, where she was held at gunpoint in a hotel. Both cases highlight the risks faced by public figures,

● **The incident has drawn comparisons to Kim Kardashian’s 2016 Paris robbery, where she was held at gunpoint in a hotel. Both cases highlight risks faced by public figures.**

even in supposedly secure environments.

Bishnoi Gang under scrutiny

The Bishnoi gang, notorious for targeting Bollywood celebrities, is under investigation.

The gang previously threatened Salman Khan and was linked to a shooting attempt on him. Saif, implicated in the blackbuck poaching case with Salman, may have been targeted for similar reasons.

Adding to concerns, Indian politician Baba Siddique—known for hosting lavish Iftar parties for Bollywood—was recently gunned down, allegedly by the same gang.

These incidents underline the growing danger posed by organised crime to high-profile individuals and have also raised questions on safety in the city of Mumbai.

SEE ALSO P15



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